SCULPTURE, POTTERY AND ICONOGRAPHY

SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL → LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL → POTTERY CHRONOLOGY → THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX → ANICONIC TO ICONIC → GUPTA BRIDGE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL

SIX-VARIABLE READING RAIL | WHAT CARVING OR CASTING PERMITS | POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE | IDENTITY AND ACTION | PATRON + SITE | COMMISSIONED CONTEXT | SIMILARITY, DIFFERENCE AND LIMIT | MUST REMEMBER

CORE CLAIM
- MATERIAL → what carving or casting permits
- POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE → identity and action
- PATRON + SITE → commissioned context

MECHANISM
- COMPARISON → similarity, difference and limit
- MUST REMEMBER: Sculpture and pottery must be read through material, technique, posture,
- attribute, patron and site, from lost-wax casting and pottery sequences to Gandhara,

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- Mathura, Amaravati, Gupta and Chola visual programmes.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Sculpture and pottery must be read through material, technique, posture, attribute, patron and site, from lost-wax casting and pottery sequences to Gandhara,.

01

STAGE 01 LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL

LOST-WAX AND LABEL FIREWALL | WAX MODEL | CLAY INVESTMENT | WAX LEAVES A CAVITY | MOLTEN METAL | BRONZE FORM | SEPARATE FROM A MUSEUM LABEL

WAX MODEL → clay investment → HEAT → wax leaves a cavity → MOLTEN METAL → bronze form → MEANING → separate from a museum label

CORE CLAIM
- WAX MODEL → clay investment
- HEAT → wax leaves a cavity

MECHANISM
- MOLTEN METAL → bronze form
- MEANING → separate from a museum label

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- WAX MODEL → clay investment
- HEAT → wax leaves a cavity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MOLTEN METAL → bronze form; MEANING → separate from a museum label.

02

STAGE 02 POTTERY CHRONOLOGY

POTTERY CHRONOLOGY | COARSE HAND-MADE WARE | AHAR, MALWA AND JORWE PAINTED WARES | SEPARATE CHRONOLOGICAL MARKERS | FINE EARLY HISTORIC TABLEWARE

NEOLITHIC → coarse hand-made ware → CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares → HARAPPAN / PGW → separate chronological markers → NBPW → fine early historic tableware

CORE CLAIM
- NEOLITHIC → coarse hand-made ware
- CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares

MECHANISM
- HARAPPAN / PGW → separate chronological markers
- NBPW → fine early historic tableware

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NEOLITHIC → coarse hand-made ware
- CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CHALCOLITHIC → Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares.

03

STAGE 03 THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX

THREE-SCHOOL MATRIX | GREY STONE, BUDDHIST, LAYERED INFLUENCE | RED STONE, THREE RELIGIONS, ATTRIBUTES | LIMESTONE, BUDDHIST NARRATIVE, TRIBHANGA | COMPARE ON THE SAME AXES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence	AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga	GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes	RULE → compare on the same axes	MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

CORE CLAIM
- GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
- MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

MECHANISM
- AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga
- RULE → compare on the same axes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- GANDHARA → grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence
- MATHURA → red stone, three religions, attributes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AMARAVATI → limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga; RULE → compare on the same axes.

04

STAGE 04 ANICONIC TO ICONIC

ANICONIC TO ICONIC | EMPTY THRONE | SYMBOLIC PRESENCE | DEVOTIONAL CHANGE | HUMAN IMAGE BECOMES CENTRAL | GANDHARA + MATHURA | OVERLAPPING EARLY-CE CONTEXTS | NO UNCONTESTED SOLE ORIGIN

EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence → DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central → GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts → CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CORE CLAIM
- EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence
- DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

MECHANISM
- GANDHARA + MATHURA → overlapping early-CE contexts
- CAUTION → no uncontested sole origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence
- DEVOTIONAL CHANGE → human image becomes central

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL → symbolic presence.

05

STAGE 05 GUPTA BRIDGE

GUPTA BRIDGE | CREAM SANDSTONE | SUBTLE MODELLING AND THIN DRAPERY | LATE OR POST-GUPTA CAUTION | RESTRAINT BEFORE DENSER TEMPLE PROGRAMMES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SARNATH → cream sandstone	SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution	SARNATH → cream sandstone
BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery	BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes	BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

CORE CLAIM
- SARNATH → cream sandstone
- BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

MECHANISM
- SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution
- BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SARNATH → cream sandstone
- BODY → subtle modelling and thin drapery

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SULTANGANJ → late or post-Gupta caution; BRIDGE → restraint before denser temple programmes.

06

STAGE 06 NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY

NATARAJA CHRONOLOGY | EARLY KNOWN ANTECEDENT | CANONICAL PORTABLE BRONZE | TEMPLE PROCESSION | RITUAL MOBILITY | PEAK IS NOT ORIGIN

AIHOLE → early known antecedent → CHOLA → canonical portable bronze → TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility → RULE → peak is not origin

CORE CLAIM
- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

MECHANISM
- TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility
- RULE → peak is not origin

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- AIHOLE → early known antecedent
- CHOLA → canonical portable bronze

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE PROCESSION → ritual mobility; RULE → peak is not origin.

07

STAGE 07 NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP

NATARAJA ATTRIBUTE MAP | CREATION AND DESTRUCTION | RAISED FOOT | REASSURANCE AND RELEASE | IGNORANCE SUBDUED | RECURRING TIME

DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction

ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release → APASMARA → ignorance subdued → AUREOLE → recurring time

CORE CLAIM
- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

MECHANISM
- APASMARA → ignorance subdued
- AUREOLE → recurring time

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DAMARU / FIRE → creation and destruction
- ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT → reassurance and release.

08

STAGE 08 LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER

LION-BULL EVIDENCE LADDER | BULL VISIBLE, MEANING UNRECOVERABLE | INSCRIBED LION, UNINSCRIBED BULL | ANIMALS INSIDE A BUDDHIST-IMPERIAL SYSTEM | NANDI, YALI AND VYALA GAIN PLACED ROLES

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable	SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system	HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull	TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles	RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

CORE CLAIM
- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
- RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

MECHANISM
- SARNATH → animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system
- TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- HARAPPAN → bull visible, meaning unrecoverable
- RAMPURVA → inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE → Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles.

09

STAGE 09 TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT

TEMPLE ANIMAL PLACEMENT | AXIAL PAVILION BEFORE SHIVA | COMPOSITE GUARDIAN ON SOUTHERN PILLARS | LION-BODIED HYBRID AT KHAJURAHO | BUILDING, GUARDIAN AND MOTIF | CLOSE DISTINCTION | GANDHARA, MATHURA AND AMARAVATI DIFFER BY MATERIAL, RELIGIOUS SCOPE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva	VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar
YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars	DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif	symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

CORE CLAIM
- NANDI → axial pavilion before Shiva
- YALI → composite guardian on southern pillars

MECHANISM
- VYALA → lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho
- DISTINCTION → building, guardian and motif

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar
- symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar; symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

10

STAGE 10 SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST

SOCIAL-EVIDENCE TEST | DANCER, MUSICIAN, TEACHER OR COUPLE | SELECTED WHAT BECAME VISIBLE | VALUED ACTIVITY OR RITUAL IDIOM | NOT A CENSUS OF SOCIETY | EVIDENCE LIMIT | PASHUPATI, MOTHER GODDESS AND PRIEST-KING ARE MODERN HARAPPAN LABELS

FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple

PATRON → selected what became visible → CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom → LIMIT → not a census of society

CORE CLAIM
- FIGURE → dancer, musician, teacher or couple
- PATRON → selected what became visible

MECHANISM
- CLAIM → valued activity or ritual idiom
- LIMIT → not a census of society

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels
- Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels; Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

11

STAGE 11 SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE

SCULPTURE ANSWER SPINE | SCHOOL, OBJECT OR SYMBOL | MATERIAL, POSTURE, ATTRIBUTE AND SITE | PERIOD OR REGIONAL WORKSHOP | ATTRIBUTION, PRIORITY AND SOCIAL INFERENCE

DEFINE → school, object or symbol → EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site → COMPARE → period or regional workshop → QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE → school, object or symbol
- EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site

MECHANISM
- COMPARE → period or regional workshop
- QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEFINE → school, object or symbol
- EVIDENCE → material, posture, attribute and site

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPARE → period or regional workshop; QUALIFY → attribution, priority and social inference.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | NO URGENT CURRENT-STATUS CORRECTION IS REQUIRED FOR THIS TOPIC'S | TREATING CHOLA PATRONAGE AS THE ORIGIN OF NATARAJA ICONOGRAPHY. | TREATING "INDO-GREEK" (GANDHARA) AS MEANING THE SCULPTURE IS | ASSUMING ICONOGRAPHIC ATTRIBUTE IDENTIFICATION ALWAYS OVER-RIDES | TREATING TRADITIONAL MUSEUM LABELS AS DECODED HARAPPAN IDENTITIES. | ASSIGNING DIDARGANJ AUTOMATICALLY TO THE MAURYAS. - ITS POLISH | TOPIC 13 OWNS THE DOCTRINAL/THEOLOGICAL SIGNIFICANCE OF

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- No urgent current-status correction is required for this topic's
- NOT: Treating Chola patronage as the origin of Nataraja iconography. - The
- NOT: Treating "Indo-Greek" (Gandhara) as meaning the sculpture is
- NOT: Assuming iconographic attribute identification always over-rides

ADVANCED DEBATE
- NOT: Treating traditional museum labels as decoded Harappan identities.
- NOT: Assigning Didarganj automatically to the Mauryas. - Its polish supports
- NOT: Topic 13 owns the doctrinal/theological significance of
- NOT: Ancient/Medieval History owns the political chronology of the

LEGACY / NUANCE
- This file's six-factor method is directly reusable for topic 03's
- Foundation companion: basic/06 Sculpture-Pottery-and-Iconography.md.
- 00 Master-Framework.md Section 2 — the "how to read a monument,
- CAUTION: Cross-links: Topic 03 (Chandella sculptural-programme dossier,

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels